RouteRefit 0.5.15 Beta

Step-by-step user guide

From your first route file to a reviewed GPX export. No route-editing experience is required. Follow the numbered steps at your own pace; blue words refer to real buttons and menus.

Single click: briefly press the left mouse button. Double-click: click twice quickly. Drag: hold the left button, move and release. Right-click opens extra choices. A control point is not the same as a waypoint.

Quick start: open a route (chapter 03), choose activity (06), align automatically (08) or manually (10), review the proposal (09) and save separately (22). Use the contents for other tasks.

The contents and PDF bookmarks are clickable. Zoom the PDF to 150% or 200% to study small screen labels. Settings are also shown as enlarged details. Standard file dialogs may use the Windows language.

All images use the same synthetic demonstration route. They contain no personal recordings. Places, values and times are examples. The documentation window is therefore marked as a guide in its title.

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01. Install and start safely

1. Run RouteRefit-0.5.15-beta-Setup.exe. Read the licence and privacy information and choose the program folder. Python is not required. Then launch RouteRefit from the Start menu.

2. Installer updates reuse the same folder and retain Mijn GPX, Kaarten and voorkeuren.json. Save your work and close the program and active road downloads first.

3. Already using a portable copy? Select that existing folder during setup to keep using its data. Setup does not move data between folders. Make a backup beforehand.

4. Prefer portable use? Extract the complete Windows ZIP and run RouteRefit-0.5.15-beta.exe with _internal alongside it. Another extracted folder has its own routes and maps.

5. Uninstall through Windows Settings > Apps. Personal data is retained. Only a background task and website association pointing to this installation are removed.

6. Background work requires a separate opt-in. When switching copies, disable it in the old copy and enable it in the new copy if wanted. Repeat after uninstalling and reinstalling.

Good to know: This beta is unsigned. Setup contains no personal routes or maps and does not enable a background task. A desktop shortcut and launching after setup are optional.

02. Choose a language and find your way

1. Open **Language**. Choose Nederlands, English, Deutsch, Français, Español or Português.
2. The application restarts after a language change. Resolve any unsaved-work question first.
3. **Routes** is for local files. **Edit route** opens the map; F6 opens elevation and statistics.
4. Open the guide through **Help**. The PDF matches the selected application language.

Good to know: Portuguese uses European terminology. Screenshots show a synthetic demonstration; their numbers are examples.

03. Open a route

1. Click **Import route…** or press Ctrl+O. Find your file, select it and click Open.
2. You can import GPX, TCX, FIT, KML, KMZ and GeoJSON. Keep the source file.
3. Wait until the line and distance appear. Opening does not require a complete road download first.
4. Read any conversion messages. Sensor values, map styles and device-specific fields are not all transferred to GPX.

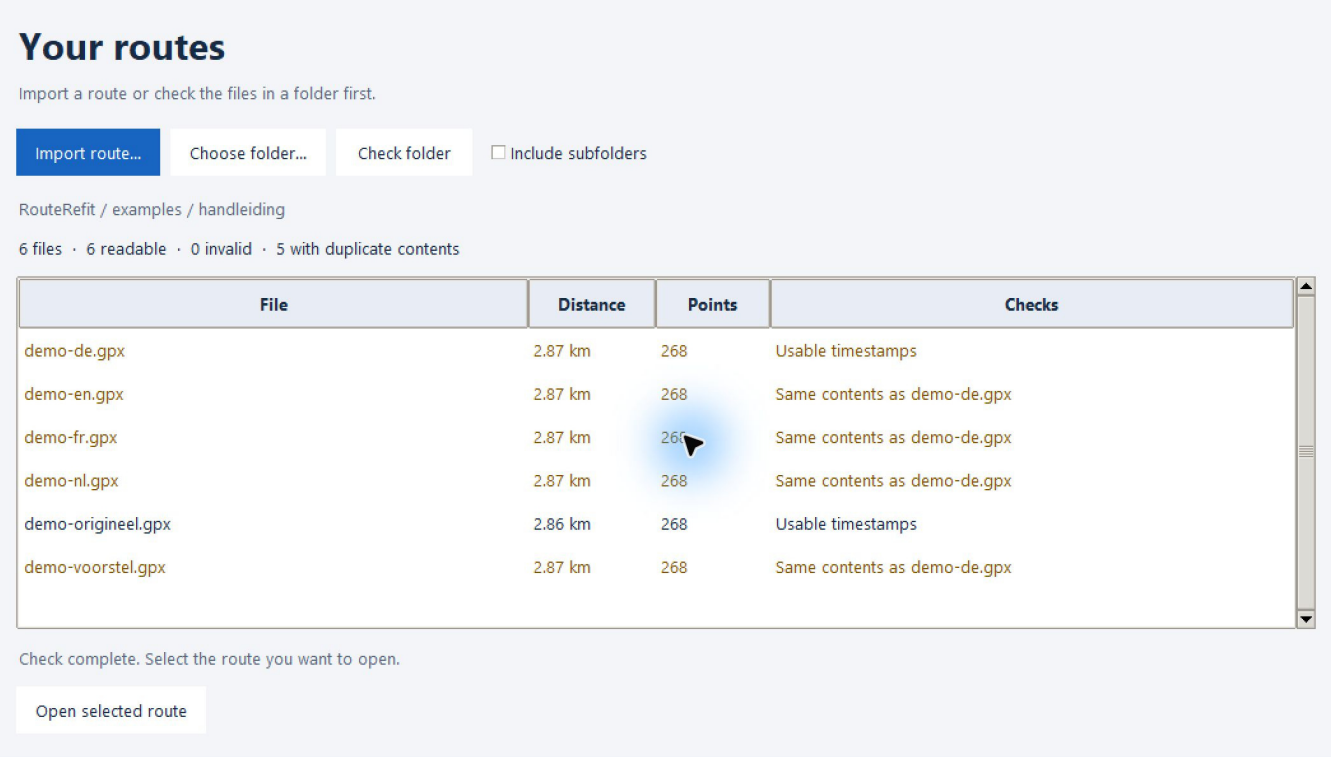
Good to know: A file must contain a route with at least two points. A waypoint-only file is not an editable route.

04. Check an entire folder

1. Go to **Routes** and choose **Choose folder…**. Select a folder containing route files.
2. Select **Include subfolders** to include nested folders. Click **Check folder**.
3. Select a row for details. Look for unreadable files, missing timestamps and duplicate contents.
4. Double-click the route you want or use **Open selected route**. Only that route opens.

Good to know: Folder checks change or delete nothing. Identical contents may have different filenames; the limit is 10,000 files per check.

Check an entire folder



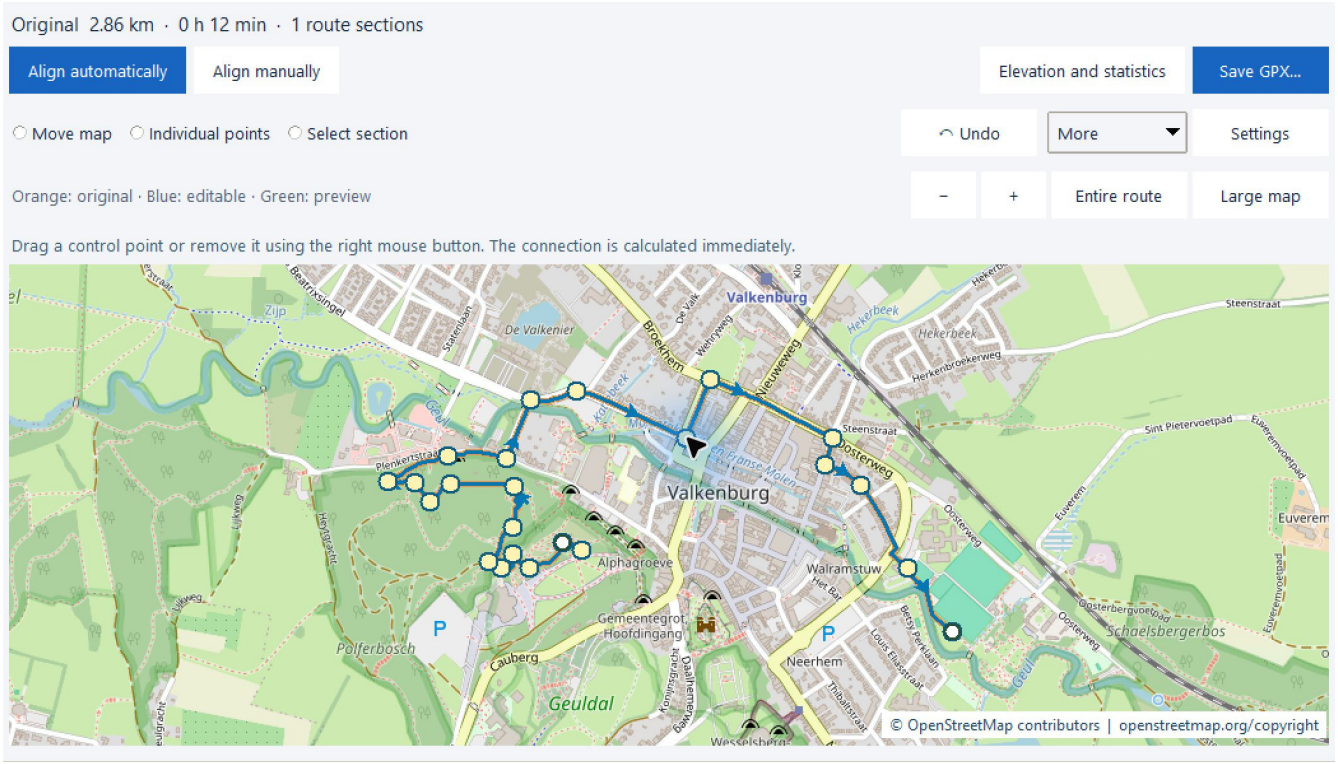
Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

05. Read and move the map

1. Remember: orange is the original, blue the editable route and green a proposal. Red requires review.
2. Choose **Move map** and drag the map. Zoom with the wheel or the + and − buttons.
3. Click **Entire route** if you lose the line. **Large map** or F11 provides more room.
4. Large yellow points are control points. Purple markers are waypoints; they do not automatically determine road choices.

Good to know: The background map and calculation road data are separate. A background outage does not make saved roads unusable.

Read and move the map



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

06. Choose an activity

1. Open **Settings** and **Activity** before aligning. Choose **Walking**, **Bicycle**, **MTB**, **Gravel bike**, **Car** or **Motorcycle**. Speed pedelec is not included.

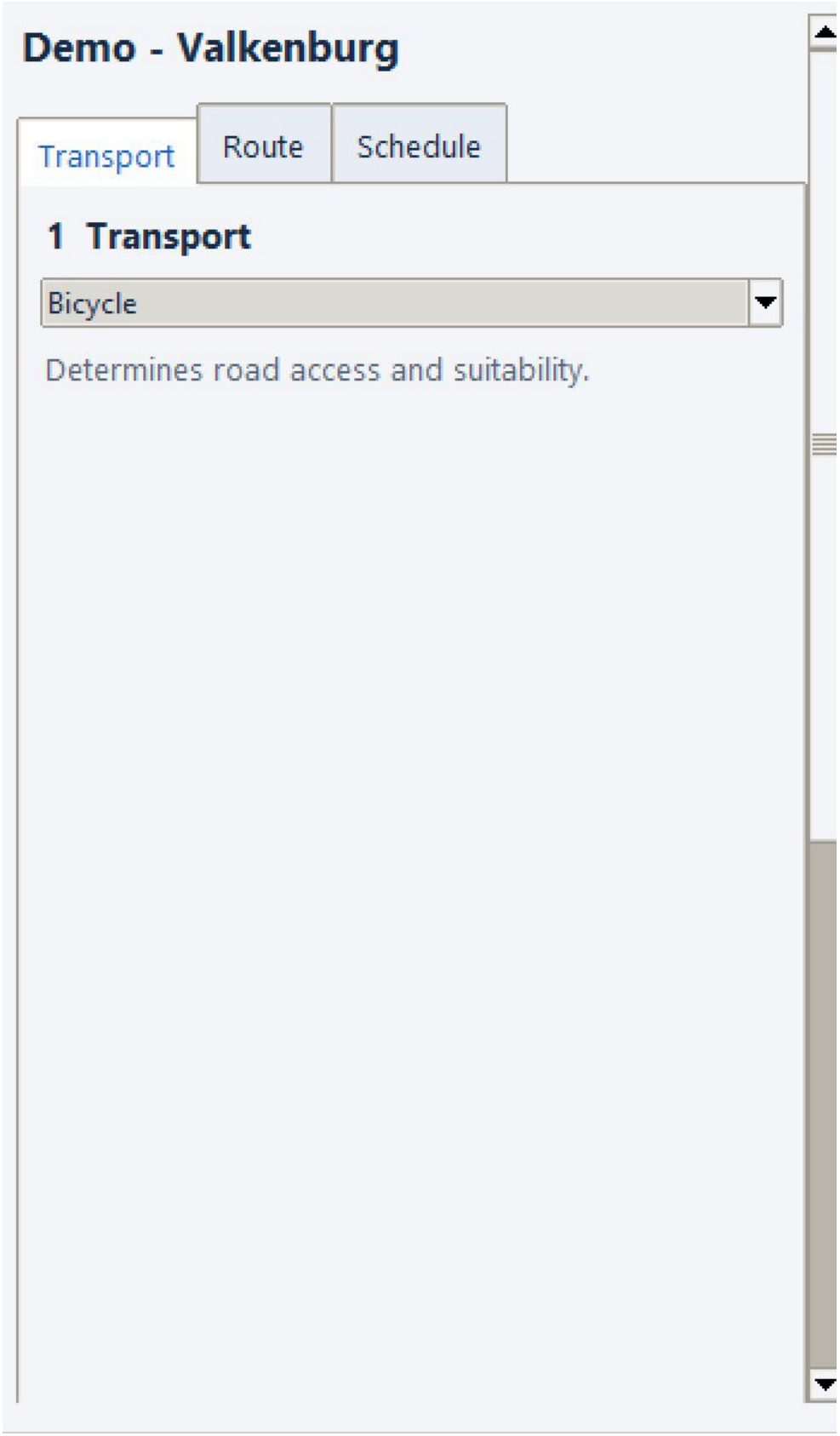
2. The activity determines access, direction and suitable roads. Gravel avoids difficult trails; cars and motorcycles do not use ordinary cycleways or footpaths without explicit permission in the map data.

3. The same local engine uses OSM data across Europe, including borders. Explicit access, one-way roads and supported turn restrictions are considered. Download enough coverage for cross-border routes.

4. Changed activity after calculating? Create a new proposal. The pace under **Schedule** does not change road choice; activity and custom speed are saved with the GPX.

Good to know: Signs and local rules remain decisive. National defaults, conditional access and vehicle dimensions are not fully modeled. Recognized conditional turn restrictions apply at all times as a precaution. Times are estimates without traffic or speed limits.

Choose an activity



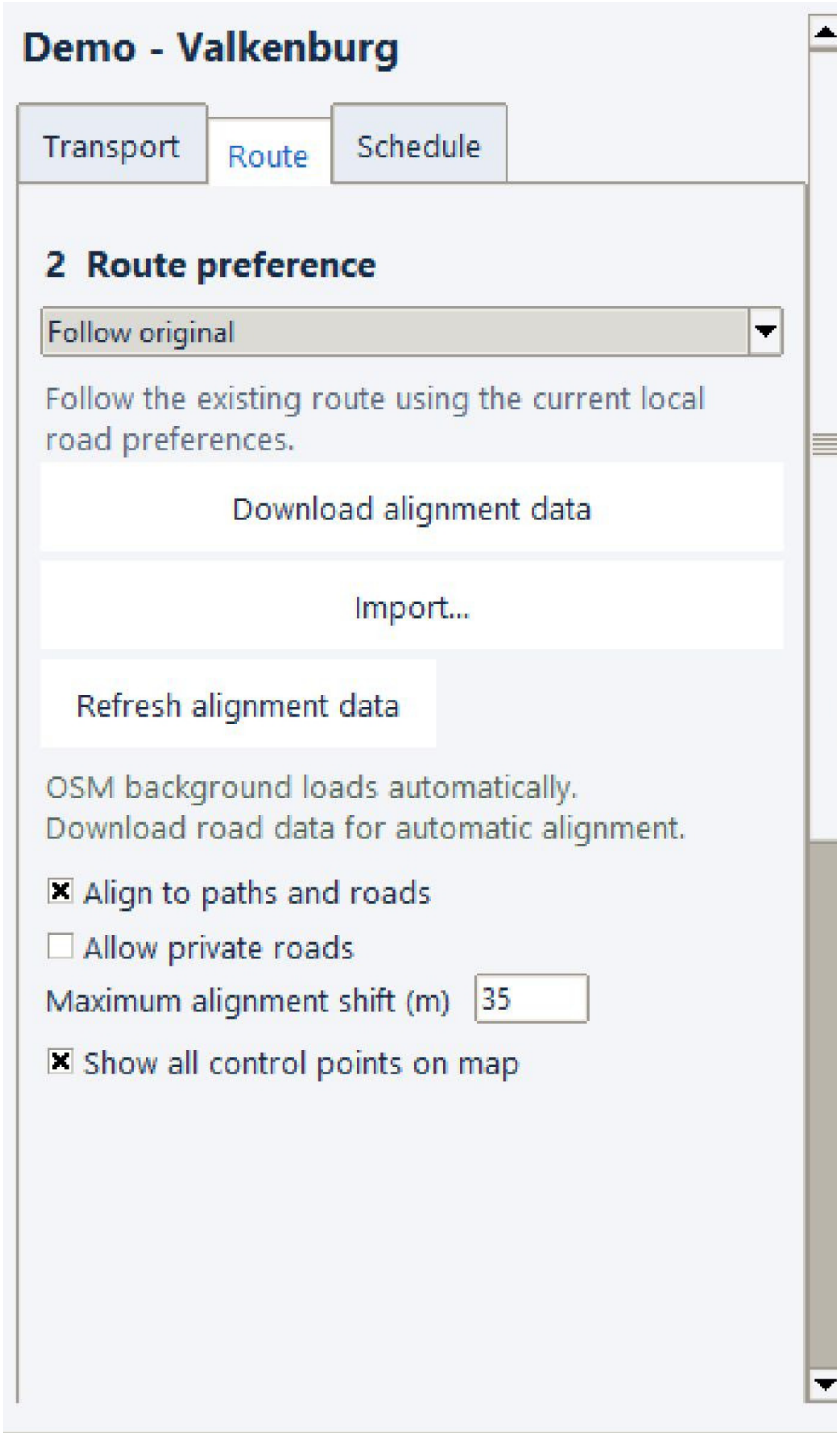
Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

07. Route preference, access and search radius

1. Open **Settings** and **Route**. The current preference is **Follow original**: follow the existing route.
2. From **Activity**, **Access and private roads…** opens the route settings directly. **Allow private roads and paths** and **Access warnings…** are near the top.
3. Leave **Allow private roads and paths** off unless you deliberately want those roads considered. The setting grants no access rights.
4. The maximum alignment shift is the search radius around route points. Start at 35 metres; the valid range is 5-150 metres.
5. Increase it only when the correct path is out of reach. Then check parallel paths and the side of the road carefully.
6. Review access warnings after checking the route. Acceptance preserves the line, elevations and times. Missing access tags do not automatically block walking or cycling; cars and motorcycles avoid ordinary cycleways and footpaths without explicit permission.

Good to know: Shortest, fastest, quiet, scenic and elevation-based alternatives are future work. Accepting an access warning does not change road selection.

Route preference, access and search radius



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

08. Align automatically and follow progress

1. Open a route, choose activity and click **Align automatically** once.
2. The indicator moves; the current step and elapsed time remain visible. This may take a while.
3. The proposal uses saved roads first. Missing roads are downloaded afterwards in the background. There are no automatic retries or new countdowns. Use Update proposal when the download is ready.
4. Use **Stop alignment** if you do not want to wait. The editable route is preserved; results are not silently applied.

Good to know: A new area first needs road data. Complete saved areas are reused, including after restart. The green line stays a proposal until you apply it.

Align automatically and follow progress



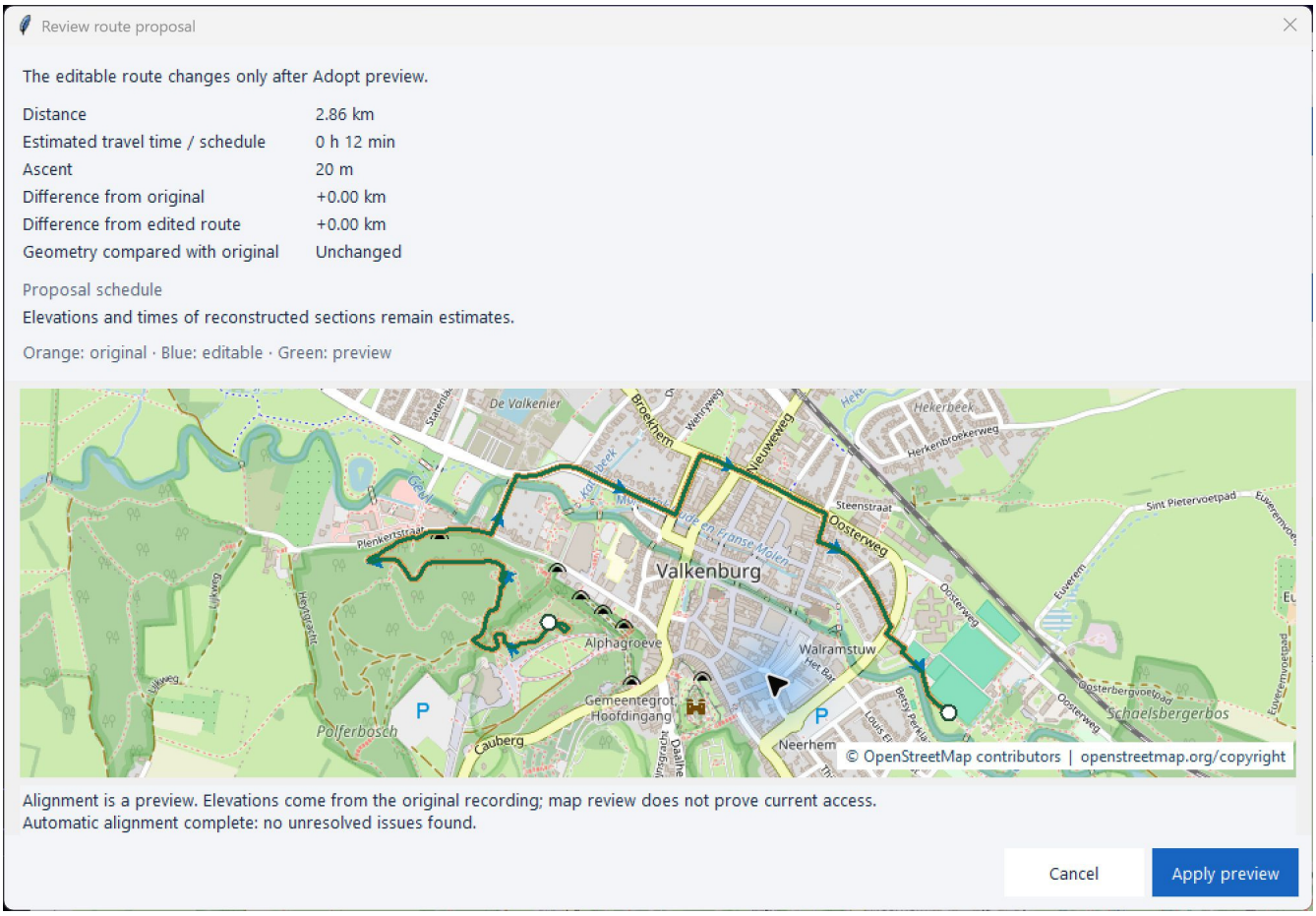
Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

09. Review and apply a proposal

1. Read distance, estimated travel time, ascent and differences from the original and edited route.
2. Zoom into junctions, parallel cycle paths and red issue markers. Check that the green line is correct.
3. Click **Cancel** if unsure. Adjust activity, search radius or control points as needed and calculate again.
4. Click **Apply preview** when satisfied. The blue route now changes; **Undo** restores the previous edit.
5. After acceptance, all yellow **Control points** are ready for further editing. Choose **Individual points** for free point corrections; automatic alignment is not needed again.

Good to know: Missing elevations produce partial totals. Reconstructed elevations and times remain estimates; a proposal does not prove actual travel time or access.

Review and apply a proposal



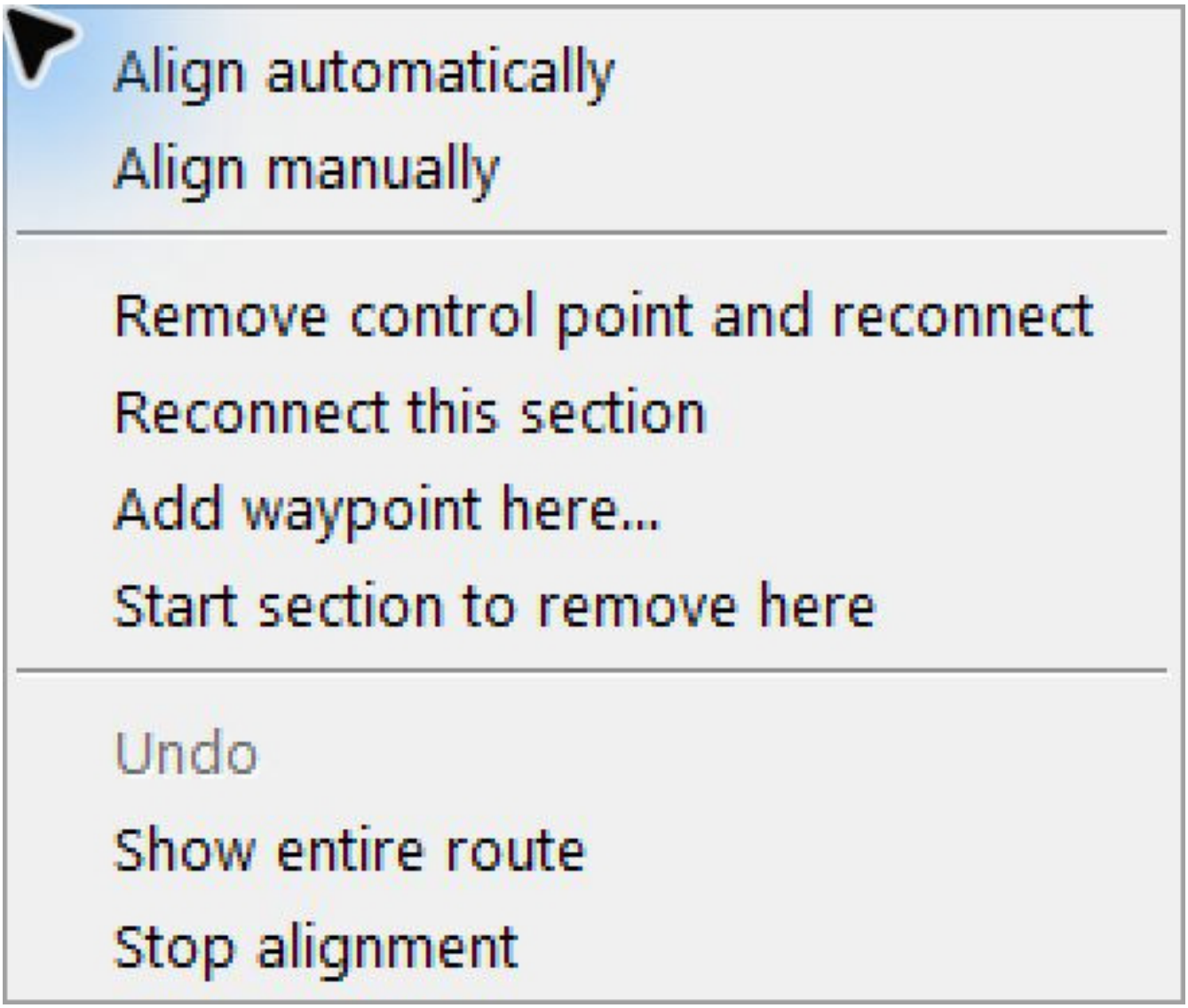
Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

10. Align manually using control points

1. Choose **Control points** or **Align manually**. After accepting an alignment proposal, this editing mode is already active and the yellow control points are visible.
2. Drag a large yellow control point onto the correct path. RouteRefit calculates connections to the neighbouring control points.
3. Right-click an unwanted control point and choose **Remove control point and reconnect**.
4. Review the replacement before applying it. The start and end control points remain.
5. Accept the local change and edit the next point immediately. **Save GPX…** saves the route, times, control points and editing mode; reopen that GPX file later to continue.

Good to know: Removing a control point also replaces the old intermediate points between its remaining neighbours. The old detour no longer guides the replacement.

Align manually using control points



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

11. Individual points and control-point density

1. Choose **Individual points** to adjust an individual recorded route point.
2. Select or drag a point. Double-click the line to add one; use the delete action for the selected point.
3. To correct along roads instead, return to **Align manually** and use the large control points.
4. Under **Route** redistribute control points using **Few**, **Normal** or **Many**. The existing line is retained.

Good to know: Moving an individual point manually differs from calculating a road connection. Use **Undo** after an incorrect change.

12. Replace an unwanted detour

1. Right-click the blue line before the detour. Choose **Start section to remove here**.
2. Right-click after the detour on the same line and choose **End section to remove here…**.
3. Review the new connection. Use replacement with via points if you need to guide its course.
4. Apply or cancel the proposal. Then check the new schedule too.

Good to know: When retaining the available average speed, a shorter route finishes earlier. New point times are estimates; pauses are not scheduled separately.

13. Move the start, end or both

1 Open **Route** and choose **Move start point**, **Move end point** or **Move start and end together**.

2 Click the desired road or path. Only its connection to the existing route is calculated.

3 Review the connection and check travel direction and the side of the path.

4 Apply the change when correct. Recalculate the schedule afterwards.

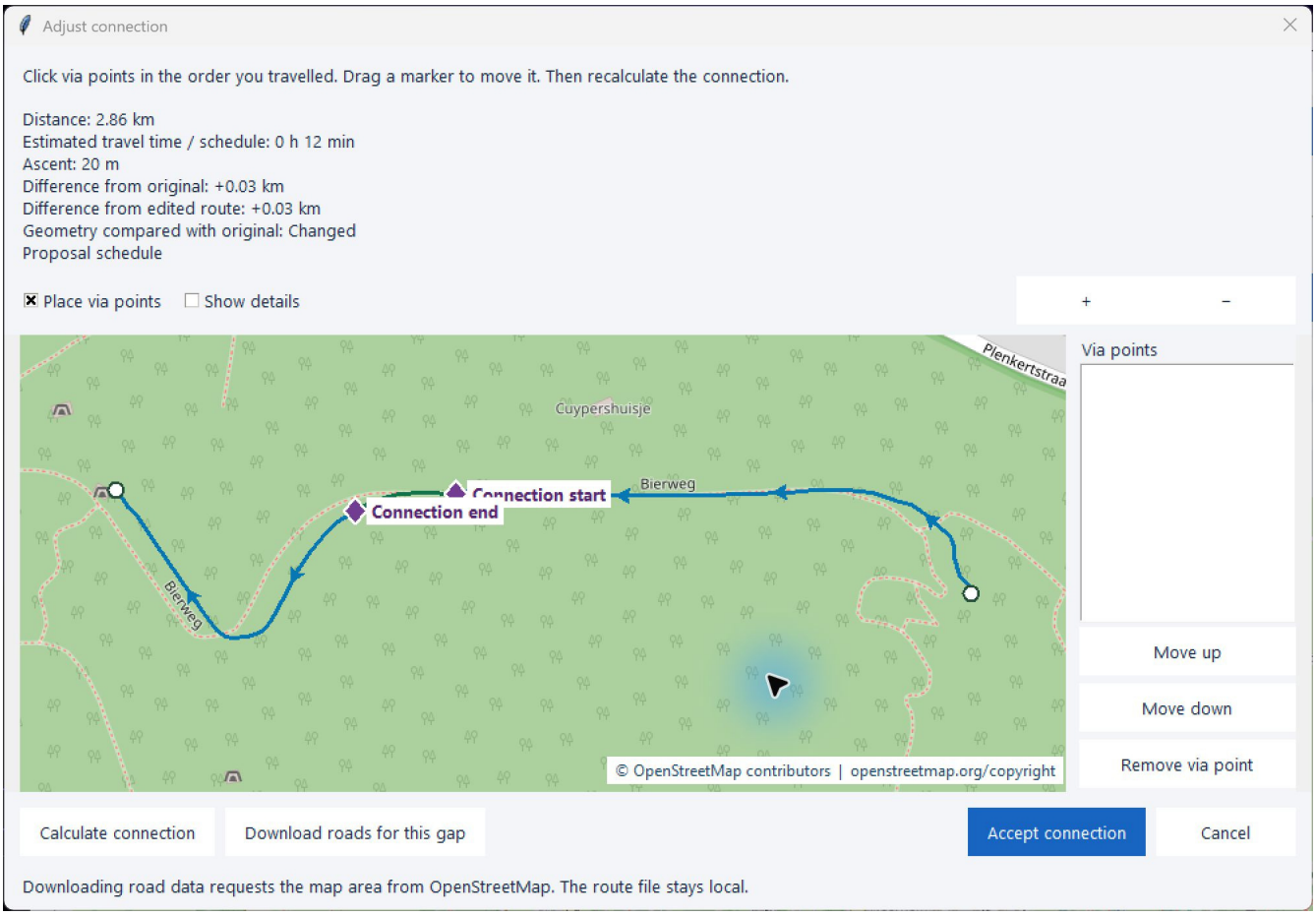
Good to know: The rest of the route is retained and has not been newly approved. Choose **Move map** to leave placement mode.

14. Understand recording gaps and segments

1. Check the number of route segments. A genuine recording gap remains identifiable as a break.
2. Adjacent TCX lap boundaries are joined on import. FIT timer stops at nearly the same position count as pauses.
3. Choose **More** → **Connect route segments…**. Select the gap you want to reconstruct.
4. Open **Adjust connection…**. Check connections to the previous and next recorded parts.

Good to know: A reconstructed connection is not a GPS recording. Accept only when you consider its proposed course appropriate.

Understand recording gaps and segments



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

15. Guide a connection with via points

1. Click locations along the desired course in the connection window, in travel order.
2. Drag a via point to move it. Use up, down or remove to correct the list.
3. Click **Calculate connection** after every change. Only then does the green line match the new via points.
4. Review the line and click **Accept connection**. Cancel leaves the separate segments intact.

Good to know: The limit is 50 via points and a 50 km connection. Missing roads are not bridged with an invented straight line. Elevations and times are identified as estimates.

16. Repair issues or deliberately keep a section

1. Use **Previous issue**, **Next issue** and **Show issue location** to inspect red markers.
2. Check activity, the side of the road and whether enough map data is available.
3. Request a repair proposal, move a control point or replace the problem section using via points.
4. To keep the recorded course, choose **Keep selected section manually**. Calculate again afterwards.

Good to know: Manual retention is a deliberate exception, not proof of road access. Unresolved sections remain identifiable; an unexpected error does not make the whole GPX unusable.

17. Understand access warnings

1. First align automatically or check again so that the issues are known.
2. Open **More** → **Access warnings…** when a problem appears to arise only from access tags.
3. Read the warning. Only issues attributable solely to those tags can be accepted this way.
4. Acceptance does not change the line, elevations or times. Your choice is recorded in the report and can be undone.

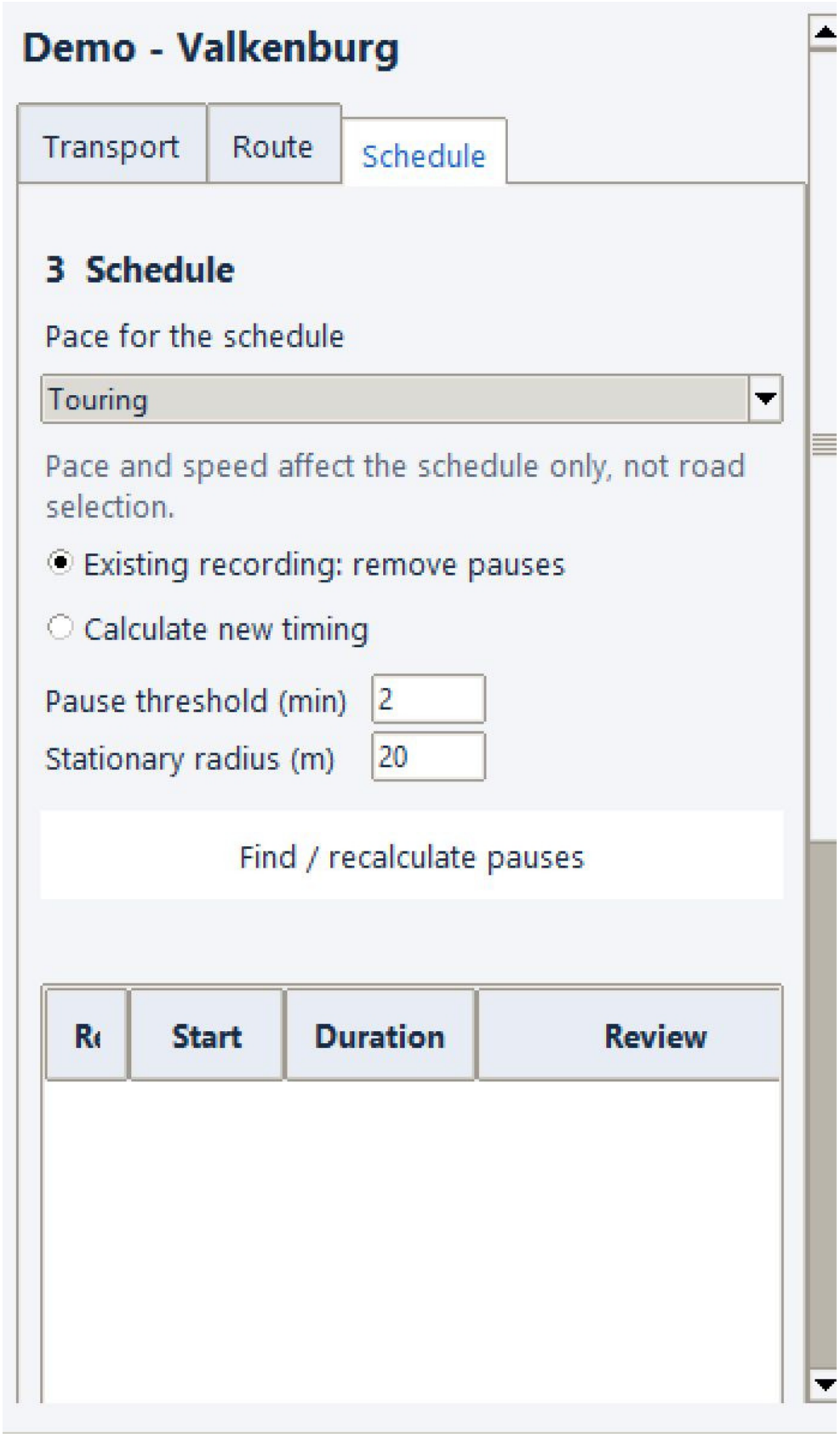
Good to know: This button does not remove a local prohibition. Observe rules and signs. Direction, missing connections and other geometry problems are not ignored by it.

18. Calculate a new schedule

1. Open **Settings** → **Schedule**. Choose a pace or enter your own level-ground speed.
2. Enter the departure time. The field uses UTC, which is not automatically your local clock time.
3. Enter a target duration only when you deliberately want that duration. Use hh:mm.
4. Choose **Calculate schedule…** through **More**. Review the proposal and its estimated times.
5. This action calculates only the times along the edited line. Manual corrections stay in place, even without downloaded roads. Use **Align automatically** only when you want to align the route again.

Good to know: Activity determines road selection; pace and speed determine the schedule. Wind, traffic lights and live traffic are not modelled. Incomplete elevations can prevent some terrain-based calculations.

Calculate a new schedule



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

19. Find and remove recorded pauses

1. Open Schedule and select editing of the existing recording by removing pauses.
2. Set the minimum pause duration and stationary radius. Use **Find pauses** or the search button beside the list.
3. Select a pause and inspect its location. Double-click a row to change its removal selection.
4. Recalculate the proposal and check the finish time. Leave genuine recording gaps alone if you do not know their meaning.

Good to know: This requires complete, increasing timestamps. Without them, recorded pauses cannot be identified reliably; deliberately choose a new estimated schedule instead.

20. Check elevation and statistics

1. Click **Elevation and statistics** or press F6. Choose **Original**, **Edited route** or **Preview**.
2. Inspect distance, duration, average speed, ascent, descent and minimum and maximum elevation.
3. Move over the graph for local values. Compare unusual peaks with the route on the map.
4. Choose **Back to map** to return. Calculate a proposal first if that choice has no data yet.

Good to know: Elevations are unfiltered; recording noise can inflate ascent. Missing elevations produce partial totals. Average speed uses the available total duration, including pauses.

Check elevation and statistics



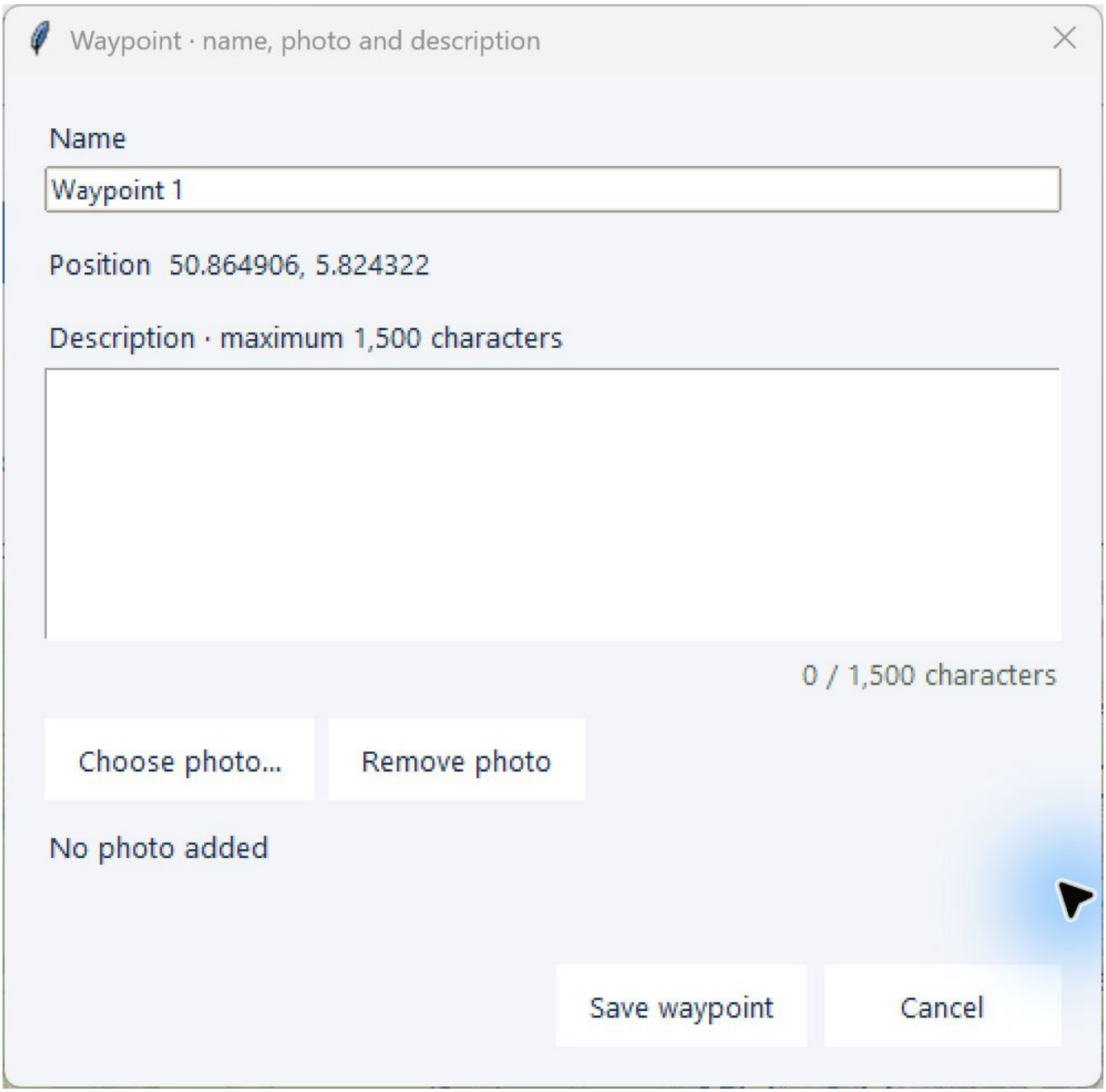
Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

21. Waypoints, descriptions and photos

1. Choose **Add waypoint** through More or the route menu and click the desired location.
2. Give the place a clear name. Optionally add a description and a photo using **Choose photo…**.
3. Click **Save waypoint**. Drag the purple marker to change its position.
4. Open **Manage waypoints** to edit, show or delete a waypoint.

Good to know: Name: at most 200 characters; description: 1,500. Photo: JPG, PNG, WebP or GIF, smaller than 25 MB and at most 60 megapixels. Move the GPX together with its accompanying photo folder.

Waypoints, descriptions and photos



Actual application view using demonstration data. Some images show an enlarged detail. Progress is illustrated with a test calculation. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL. Controls and features are from RouteRefit 0.5.5 Beta.

22. Save GPX and the check report

1. First review the line, times and messages. Apply the route proposal you want.
2. Choose **Save GPX...** or Ctrl+S. Respond to any question about a calculated proposal or a draft.
3. Choose a new filename and location. Existing files are not overwritten.
4. Keep the GPX, check report and any photo folder together. Reopen the export for a final check.

Good to know: Output is GPX, including after FIT or TCX import. The report retains choices and estimates. A draft is not a new complete approval. The source file remains separately preserved.

23. Compare original and adjusted routes

1. Open the original route. Save your edits before opening a different comparison.
2. Under **File**, choose comparison with an adjusted route and select the second GPX.
3. Read orange as original, blue as adjusted and red as requiring review.
4. Use next and previous changed location when the accompanying report contains those locations.

Good to know: A different segment structure may require opening the adjusted GPX separately. Comparing does not retrospectively change the original recording.

24. Local maps, offline work and refresh

1. Align a route. Complete downloaded areas automatically enter the local road index.
2. Later open the same or another route in that area. The index first finds existing data and downloads only missing parts.
3. Use **Import local OSM file…** for a complete bounded OSM XML region. PBF and images cannot be used for this.
4. Choose **Refresh alignment data** when you want current data. Do this only with an Internet connection.

Good to know: The map date is the OSM snapshot date or otherwise the file date. Index creation takes time once. The XML-file limit is 128 MB. The background map has a separate cache and may still be missing offline.

25. Website catalogue and automatic opening

1. **My route overview** is an optional website catalogue. The public package starts with an empty list.
2. Import only a catalogue you deliberately want to use. A website route is downloaded when you open it.
3. The upload action opens your browser. RouteRefit does not publish routes automatically or store a website password.
4. Under File, you can enable automatic opening of new GPX files in Downloads. It is off by default.

Good to know: Local file import needs no website account. Use catalogue and upload features only if they suit your workflow; nothing is being sent to GitHub or SignPath.

26. What to do when waiting or after an error

1. Is the indicator moving and elapsed time increasing? Work is still running. Read the current step.
2. The proposal uses saved roads first. Missing roads are downloaded afterwards in the background. There are no automatic retries or new countdowns. Use Update proposal when the download is ready.
3. If the road download ultimately fails, try again later. Valid saved tiles remain; this does not make your route invalid.
4. If a result is wrong, cancel, check settings and use control or via points. Use Undo after applying an unwanted result.

Good to know: RouteRefit also works without a region package. Missing roads are downloaded during alignment, which can make route calculation take much longer. Saved roads are always reused.

27. Shortcuts, preservation and future work

1. Ctrl+O opens a route; Ctrl+S starts saving. F6 opens statistics; F11 gives the map more room.
2. A control point guides the line. A via point guides a connection proposal. A waypoint describes a place.
3. Keep Mijn GPX, Kaarten and voorkeuren.json when upgrading. Also make your own backup of original routes and edits.
4. More activity profiles come after testing these language and usability changes. Creating routes from scratch is being prepared, not yet offered.

Good to know: Merging separate files and splitting into separate files remain future features. This beta is not the stable 1.0 release and is not digitally signed yet.

28. Optional region packages: faster alignment

1. RouteRefit also works without a region package. Missing roads are downloaded during alignment, which can make route calculation take much longer. Saved roads are always reused.

2. Open **Map** > **Region packages…**. Find a province or region. Prefer a small region; downloads over 500 MB are rejected.

3. Use Ctrl or Shift to select multiple regions, including different countries. Searching preserves your selection. Check the download-list count. Packages download one after another and their roads are combined for alignment. Include the neighbouring region near a border.

4. Select the region and choose **Download / update**. The initial download and preparation may take several minutes and require extra disk space. You can keep working.

5. Wait until the region is ready. Open your route, check the activity and choose **Align automatically**. Only roads near the route are read from the local index.

6. The six activities are explained in chapter 6 and navigation export in chapter 32. Drawing routes from scratch is not yet available.

Good to know: Free, without an account. Geofabrik receives your IP address and selected region, but not your GPX, times or edits. Details: https://download.geofabrik.de/technical.html

29. Updating region packages efficiently

1. Keep **Update downloaded regions weekly in the background** enabled for weekly checks by default while RouteRefit is open. Disable it to stop future automatic checks.
2. To update now, open **Map** > **Region packages...**, enable **Downloaded only**, select a region and choose **Download / update**.
3. An up-to-date region is not downloaded or indexed again. Otherwise small daily change files update only changed roads and affected points.
4. Updates are prepared and checked separately. **Stop** or a failure preserves the existing package. There are no repeated countdowns; a failed automatic check is not retried automatically for at least one day.
5. Changed boundaries, old data or excessive changes require **Download again**. A full download never starts silently. Updates do not change an open route or proposal; choose **Align automatically** again.

Good to know: The list shows the OSM data date. A weekly check does not guarantee daily supplier changes. Keep the Kaarten folder when upgrading RouteRefit; it contains your packages and their settings. See chapter 31 for continuing after closing; this option is off by default.

30. Draw a custom download area

1 Open **Map** > **Region packages...** > **Draw custom area...**. Areas may cross national borders. Existing packages remain available.

2 Enter a local name. Drag a **Rectangle** or click the corners of a **Polygon**. Correct with **Undo last point** or **Clear**. Pan and zoom as needed.

3 Leave 1-2 km around routes. The enclosing rectangle may cover at most 2500 km². Smaller areas reduce download and processing work; supplier queues can still cause delays.

4 Read the privacy explanation and choose **Download area via SliceOSM**. Only the drawn boundary and your IP go to the service. The name, GPX, times and edits stay local. The boundary is accessible through the download link.

5 Progress has three stages: downloading (including supplier preparation), local processing and checking. **Stop** preserves existing packages. A slow supplier request can be resumed manually later.

6 Refresh custom areas manually with **Download / update**. This downloads the small area again, without daily change files. A reminder appears after a week. Alignment also works without packages, but missing roads may take much longer to obtain.

Good to know: SliceOSM is free and requires no account, but may log usage data. https://github.com/SliceOSM/.github/blob/main/PRIVACY.md . Packages contain routing roads; background map images are separate. Speed is not guaranteed.

31. Background work and available computing power

1 By default, closing RouteRefit stops region jobs. No Windows startup task is created. Weekly checks then run only while the application is open.

2 To continue after closing, open **Region packages…** and explicitly enable **Continue when RouteRefit is closed (Windows background task)**. Windows creates a task for your user at sign-in and daily at 09:00. No administrator rights or map-service account are needed.

3 Start a region download or update. A separate process continues after closing RouteRefit. Windows must be awake and you must be signed in. The task does not wake the computer. Route calculations and editing are not continued in the background.

4 The daily task checks which Geofabrik packages are due for their weekly update. The weekly setting still applies. Custom areas are refreshed manually; an already-started download can continue after closing.

5 **Stop** stops the current region job. Disabling the background option stops background work and removes the Windows task. Network failures do not trigger repeated new requests. After interruption by Windows, resume manually.

6 Map files are decoded in parallel where possible. With little competing CPU load, processing runs at normal speed with a bounded memory buffer. Under heavy load, map work gets lower priority and extra pauses. Processing remains separate from the interface.

Good to know: Enabling is always your choice. Routes, times and settings are not sent to the download provider. Existing packages are replaced only after the new version passes validation.

32. Navigation routes for Komoot, Garmin and Strava

1. Check the line and accept the proposal. Keep the editable GPX with its review report to continue later. Connect recording gaps if you need one continuous navigation route.

2. **Export to**: click Komoot, Garmin or Strava. **Save GPX and open upload page** saves the navigation line and elevations without times. Select the file on the website and confirm the import there.

3. Komoot: choose a planned route and retain its original shape. Garmin: import in Courses and send to a compatible device. Strava: import in the route planner; a subscription may be needed. Activity export with adjusted times remains under **Export to…**.

4. After import, check the line, activity and who can see the route. **Copy file path** helps locate the file. Open the saved route on your phone or compatible navigation device.

Good to know: Export is local and free. Files omit photos, waypoints and personal metadata; locations remain visible. RouteRefit never uploads automatically. Services have their own terms and possible fees. Keep the regular GPX with its review report for further editing.

33. Local files: GPX, TCX and KML

1. Check the line and accept the proposal. Keep the editable GPX with its review report to continue later. Connect recording gaps if you need one continuous navigation route.

2. For local files: **File…** > GPX, TCX or KML > **Save file…**. Also available via File > **Export route file…**. GPX is for navigation; KML for mapping programs. Both omit times. TCX is a course with existing route times.

3. Choose **Set date and speed for TCX** to use the calendar, time picker and average speed. This opens automatically if usable times are missing. New times are estimates; walking/cycling requires complete elevations. Your editable route is unchanged.

4. Choose a new filename; existing files are never overwritten. Separate sections stay separate. KML needs at least two points per section. After import, check the line, times, activity and visibility; support varies by program/device.

Good to know: Export is local and free. Files omit photos, waypoints and personal metadata; locations remain visible. RouteRefit never uploads automatically. Services have their own terms and possible fees. Keep the regular GPX with its review report for further editing.